Perceived Credence of all-caps journal titles in academic databases from high school perspectives across grades

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Introduction

Recently, It has become increasingly clear that the contents of a title can have a meaningful impact on the perceived credibility of an entire source. A great example is the influence of epistemic language. Epistemic language employs factive verbs like “knows” or “confirms”, and a paper by Chuey and others found how that language could alter objectivity perceptions, with participants being less likely to believe news headlines that used less effective verbs and had more nonfactive verbs like “believes” (2024). The understanding of how certain word choices like epistemic are expansive, but the understanding of other stylistic choices ,such as all-caps, is more oversimplified. Most papers, such as Witchel and others researching shouting capitalization(another name for all-caps) hold the assumption that shouting capitalization is like yelling and can damage the credibility of online journal content (2019). But this assertion is an inadequate description of how all-caps can influence opinions and perspectives. Maria Heath illuminates the full extent of all-caps influence with her discussion of the prosodic nature of all-caps and how all-caps can cause more than just the feeling of someone shouting (2018). This study intends to further dive into all-caps’ effect in specific contexts, and whether there was context which the body of knowledge has yet to address.

Literature Review

All-caps

All-caps is the full capitalization of text. It is conventionally seen as shouting capitalization. What that means is that all-caps emulate the effect of shouting for a reader, which could damage the perceived credibility of content like online health forums (Witchel et al.,2019). As a result, the impact of all-caps on perceptions is seen as purely negative. However, this stems from a misinterpretation of how all-caps actually alters reader perceptions. What instead matters is the context of where all-caps are used.

Prosodic nature

The influence of all-caps and how readers perceive them is not always negative.Instead, it is a cognitive matter, where readers' perceptions are built based on the context of the all-caps use. As Maria Heath posits, a reader's interpretation of all-caps is ultimately prosodic (2018). Prosodic essentially means that all-caps can create a more heightened emotional or linguistically stressed interpretation. Furthermore, these heightened interpretations can lead to different final perceptions based on the context of the all-caps titles. These can range from contexts like advertisements, brands, and social media.

Xiaobing and others papers assess a brand context. They found that all-caps wordmarks(stylized brand titles) actually resulted in a more authoritative and trustworthy interpretation of the brand (Xu et al.,2017). In social media, a study found that all-caps was the "equivalent to yelling at clients”, suggesting it comes across as informal (does your practice “like” social media?, 2011). And in Klinke and others papers, all-caps for advertising were found to have no influence on the perception of the ad in their experiment and instead just made it harder for participants to read and

comprehend the all-caps text (Klinke et al., 2024). This suggests that all-cap might not even have a discernible effect on perceptions depending on the context.

Gap

Despite extensive research in so many different contexts, there is a limited understanding of how all- caps can influence perceptions for academic titles. This is mostly the result of all-caps' stigmatization in academia. In Allison Christians paper, designed to inform law students on how to write a cohesive academic paper, he stresses students to adopt a professional tone in your writing by avoiding inappropriate emphasis using italics, boldface, exclamation points, all-caps, and other informalities…" (2020). Due to the negative connotations associated with all-caps, it is rarely used within academic papers. However, such research fails to recognize the circumstances surrounding academic journal titles. Journal articles have to adhere to specific formatting requirements from the journal. This can result in some journals requiring fully all-caps titles. The Journal of Management Theory and Practices Research supports this, as they mandate their authors to fully capitalize their article titles (2021).

Academic titles convey several important details to audiences. As described in the process of writing academic science papers, Drake and others work highlight how titles communicate a paper's subject, the verb (the action which takes place), and the scope of the project so as to dismiss inconsequential or irrelevant details(2025).

Furthermore, as Good and Bolman report, the title is one of the most crucial parts of a successful paper: "people may evaluate reading an article in part based on the title" (2024). Even though a strong title is so imperative to the success of an article, it is still unclear how all-caps influences reader perceptions. This cumulates into the studies research question: "How does the

all-caps style of titles for academic journals affect the perceived credibility of those journals in the eyes of high school students across grades?

High school focus

The study elected to look at a specific demographic, since the research in the literature review rarely incorporated looks at specific demographics besides gender. A general circumstance was that the demographic had to have a moderately high percentage of members who have already used a database. The reason this study then targets specifically high school students is because of two factors: use data and netiquette. In a study that assessed high school knowledge about literacy, it was found from a body of 375 first year college students that while in high school 67% of them had used a library database (Correll 2019). Despite this, there is no concrete understanding of how these high school students would end up interacting with all-caps titles in an academic context. The second factor was netiquette, which is standards of etiquette designed for the internet. It is known from Florence Martin and others work that at a very young age middle schools are taught netiquette, including general disencouragements all-caps (2018). Further research found that this belief in netiquette is retained in high school, with results from Pandey's and others' paper finding that high schools still broadly believe in the importance of netiquette(2023). So if high schoolers are taught from an early age to see all-caps as negative, that suggests there could be a change in perceptions because of said all-caps.

There is an understanding, based on lessons of netiquette, that students may negatively interact with all-caps in social media. Social media and academics, however, are two completely different contexts that have different rules and

expectations. Furthermore, high school students frequently interact with academic journals. The idea that students are taught and have committed beliefs against all-caps is an interesting premise. The paper then gains the capacity to explore if that commitment can actually influence student evaluations, a prospect which neither the college level nor the middle school could adequately fulfill.

The reason high school students were chosen in lieu of college level students(or both) was because of what that netiquette retention entails. The reason while high schoolers were chosen instead of middle schoolers was because there is no concrete data about middle school database use while there was existing data on high school use

High School Year difference

This paper will also focus on how perceptions are changed based on the year of high school a participant is in. This is because of the change in expectations for academic writing as high school students progress as well as the different levels of experience. Looking at Pandey and others papers it was found that age found has a strong association with student commitment to netiquette (2023). However, in Estacio's paper, there was no discernible difference in performance when comparing grade levels for a student research task(2018). Because of the uncertainty of influence, this variable more so serves to further enrich the high school focus of the paper.

Gender is not being considered in the study. As Estacio's paper finds, gender had a negligible effect on student performance in the research tasks (2018). Pandey's paper also supports the lack of an effect, suggesting that negative perceptions of all-caps will most likely not vary because of gender distinctions.

Method

Design

From December 16th to January 25th, I sent out digital surveys to [redacted] students through email. Because the focus of the study is the relationship between all-caps and participant perception, the study design used was true experimental. The independent variable which was manipulated for this study was use of all-caps, and the dependent variable was the resulting change in perception. To bolster the true experimental design, the study based the actual experiment on Xu and others research, where they would randomly assign either a lowercase or all-caps wordmark(brand names) and asked participants to evaluate them(2017). Rather than giving a single title, a survey would provide numerous. Then, the survey was split into three different versions, with two having an overbearing amount of sentence case or all-cap which retains a similar idea to Xu and others and another being more balanced. Participants were not given a survey version based on any previous criteria, and The three different versions changed how many titles were in all-caps and how many were in the sentence case. This had ensured that perceptions were being influenced by all-caps and not just the titles used in the survey. Version 1(V1) acted as a control group, containing a relatively equal mix of all-caps and sentence case titles with just 1 more. Version 2 (V2) and Version 3(V3) responses acted as the experimental group, containing more and less capitalized titles respectively. The exact breakup in terms of all-caps to sentence case was 6-4 for V1, 7-3 for V2, and 3-7 for V3. The larger difference between V1 and V2 was just done in order to ensure all titles had at least one version in which they were capitalized and one version in which they were sentence case titles. They all used the same titles, with each title coming from a different principle or field of study. Each version of the survey was 5 minutes long. The surveys were composed of 13 questions. The first question asks if the participant has finished the survey, with accepted responses being

“Yes” or “No”. This was to provide the participant with the option to opt out of the survey. The second question asks whether the participant has used an academic database before; the third just asks what year of high school the participant is in, with the options being “Freshman”, “Sophomore”, “Junior”, and “Senior”. The remaining 10 questions provided students with article titles as prompts. The responses used an adopted form of a self report likert scale which had answers ranging from “I think this title is very credible” to "I think this title is very uncredible”(see Appendix C for full list). The titles (see Appendix C for full list) were chosen based on the fact that many of these titles had heavy technical terminology. This was done instead of a mix alongside more simple titles to prevent jargon, which is the usage of technical words, from influencing participant decisions. The decision was informed by the research of Bullock and others, which contended that jargon can actually impede attempts at persuasion and make readers more resistant to engaging with content (2019). Essentially, if jargon can make readers more resistant in persuasion, it can influence participants to decide to instead look at other stylistic choices to inform their evaluations.

The titles used in the study were also from generally different subjects. This is because the content covered in different principles are mostly different, preventing participants from evaluating based off of content trends and instead focusing on all-caps. As an example Altay and others papers title is “Media literacy tips promoting reliable news improve discernment and enhance trust in traditional media” while Gunnerson and others paper is titled “Religious employment and the tensions between liberty and equality”(2024 & 2026). While both titles have a general structure of subject to verb to scope, the actual content presented is different. That means participants could not evaluate them on the same grounds if the titles were presented in the survey.

This aligned with the research question because it ensured that all other potential externalities, such as distinction in jargon or principle, were removed. That is to say that participants were far less likely to respond based on other variables besides the studies focus on all-caps.

Data analysis

The study utilizes both qualitative and quantitative variables. The qualitative variables are the individual responses given by the participants. The quantitative data is based around the collective responses, such as how many participants responded to Question A with answer B. This was to allow for a stronger representation of the effects on perceptions because of all-caps. For example, If all-caps had an effect, then the quantitative data could gauge how that subsequently influenced responses. The method includes additional information like age and experience to further expound on that understanding.

Ethical concerns

There were few risks in the study. The only noticeable risk that existed was if a participant felt uncomfortable about a topic covered in a title. In order to mitigate this risk, the fields that are included were extremely benign and unlikely to provoke a strong response while still not including too much jargon. Both students and guardians(see Appendix A and B) were provided consent that they would sign, which informed them of this potential risk. They were then provided 2 weeks before the survey was sent to give them for either guardian or student to elect to withdraw from the study. Furthermore Question 1 was designed for the potential scenario where a participant might feel uncomfortable, offering them another chance to opt out of the survey. There were no major risks to the researcher themselves. They did not have to interact with the participants in person, and they had no noticeable biases towards the selected

titles. However, if the process had begun to stress them emotionally, then they would schedule counseling interventions. Participating individuals were to expect no compensation from this study. Gains in knowledge, however, did exist. They were primarily for high school students. All of these journal articles are, for their niches, incredibly comprehensive and insightful. If it is true that a negative perception of a detail like capitalization is causing students to refrain from using articles, even if they are quality, then this could encourage students to take a deeper look into journals rather than just making a presumption about quality. The ethical standards of this study were verified by the schools Institutional Review Board (IRB) committee, which ensured that the study posed minimal risks to both participants and researchers.

Credibility Cumulative

To best express the qualitative value of participant inputs in a quantitative manner, some responses were taken and then assigned a numerical value. Neither the first nor second questions warranted quantification as they would not be used in the results section. The third question was based on the students' grade level, with Freshman, Sophomore, Junior, and Senior given values of 1, 2, 3, and 4 respectively. The final 10 questions, with likert scale responses of "I find this very credible", "I find this title credible", "I find this title somewhat credible", "I find this title uncredible", and "I find this title very uncredible" had assigned values of 2, 1, 0 ,-1, and -2 respectively. The specifics of how the Credibility Cumulative(CC) was added up depended on the variable that perceptions were being compared to. The CC exists just to make presenting overall trends visually easier as having one composite score takes up less space than several values.

Correlational value

Correlational value scores served as supplements to CC. Correlational values used the sheets function of the same name, which computed how strong the correlation between two selected variables were and provided a value ranging from -1 to 1. Correlational value, however, does not provide a meaningful way to visualize the data since it is just one value, so it could not function as the data that would be translated into a graph.

Results

The study had a total sample size of 24 participants collected over the span of two months, with 9 completing V1, 8 completing V2, and 7 completing V3. All variants of the survey had a total of 13 questions. Three of these questions were consistent across every version, with the first question asking if the participant has completed the survey, the second question asking their high school grade level, and the third question asking if the participant has used an academic database. The remaining ten questions retained the same titles, but had varying capitalization depending on the survey version. For example, V3 would have 7 Sentence Case titles and 3 all-caps while V2 would have the reverse. The focus of the study was to understand the correlation between high school student perceptions of credibility and all-caps titles of academic journals. The question, as a result, was: How does the all-caps style of titles for academic journals affect the perceived credibility of those journals in the eyes of high school students across grades?

The first question was only designed to provide an option for participants to opt out of completing the whole survey. For the second question, 100% of participants responded that they have used a database before, so it was not possible to run correlational analysis between former use of databases and CC.

Grade level vs. CC

The second question was designed in order to understand if there was a correlational relationship between student age and CC. For grade level, CC took individual students' survey responses to the 10 title evaluation questions and added it up. This would mean that if a student gave a score of 2 (I find this title very credible) to all titles, they would have a CC of 20. There are 4 grade levels in Ridge: Freshman, Sophomore, Junior, and Senior. The form with the most balanced quantity was V3, with 2 Seniors, 2 Juniors, 2 Sophomores and 1 Freshman.

The Credibility Cumulative scores in V3 had little correlation. Scores within grades were not always consistent, as evidenced by one Sophomore having a credible cumulative score of eight while the other had a score of zero. Furthermore, there were no major distinctions amongst different grades. The inconsistency among results suggests that perceptions of credibility may be more the result of personal assumptions and bias than just grade level. The overall correlation value was 0.433586609 and the average score was 6 with only 2 noticeable outliers. Seniors had the highest Credibility Cumulative with 14 combined.

Figure 1: High School Grade vs. CC(V3)

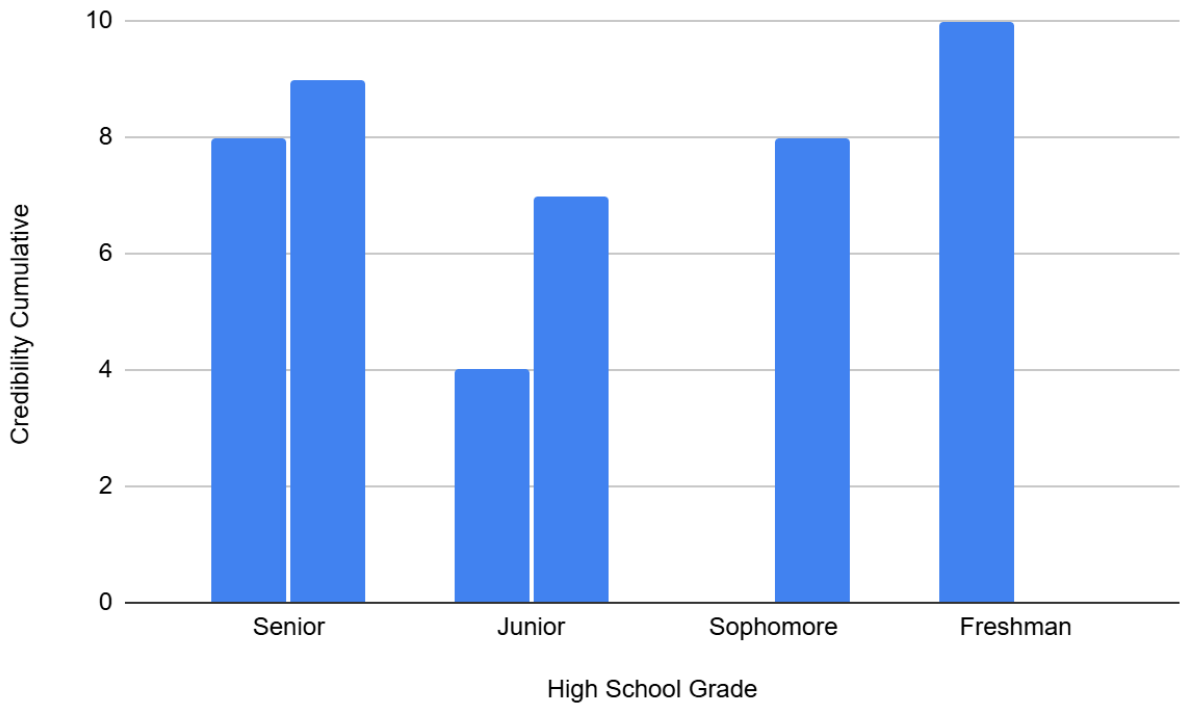


Figure 2 focuses on the same correlation but for the V2 survey. V2 had 3 Seniors, 3 Juniors, 1 Sophomores, and 1 Freshman. The relative lack of consistency again suggests that personal assumption takes precedence over grade level and subsequent experience. For example, while two juniors had relatively high scores, one had a much lower CC of 2. The Correlation value was 0.3126526997 and the average score was seven rounded up. Seniors had the highest overall Credibility Cumulative with 22 combined.

Figure 2: High School Grade vs. CC(V2)

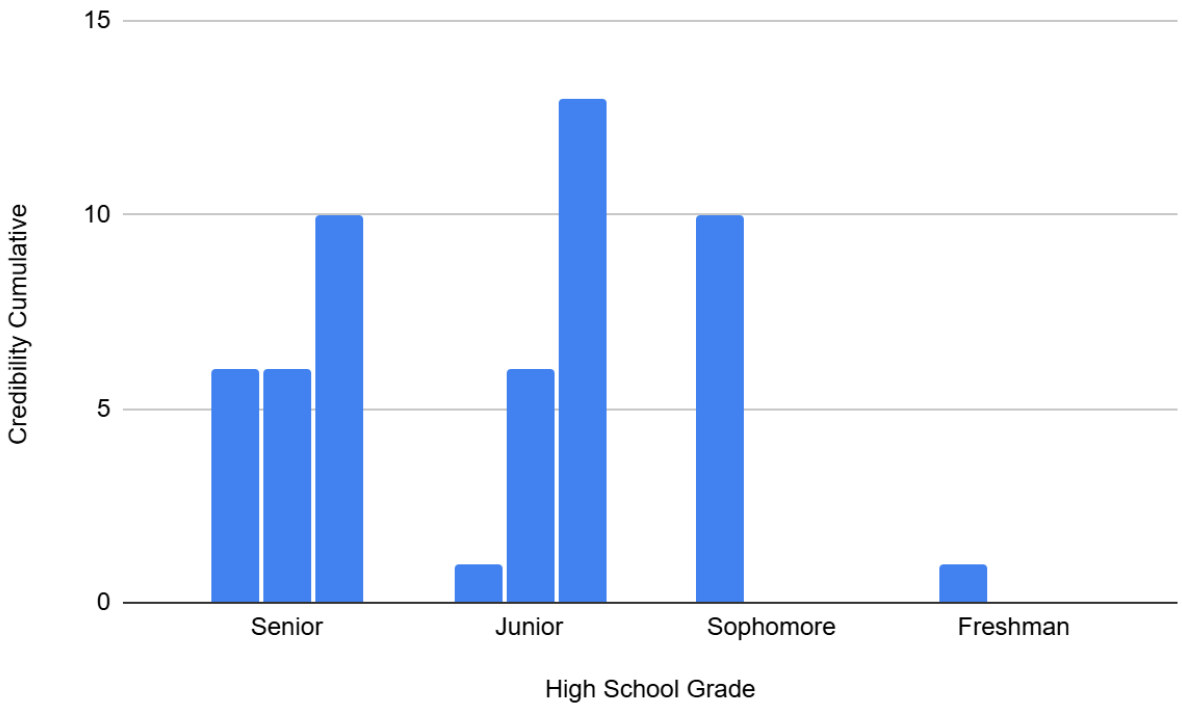
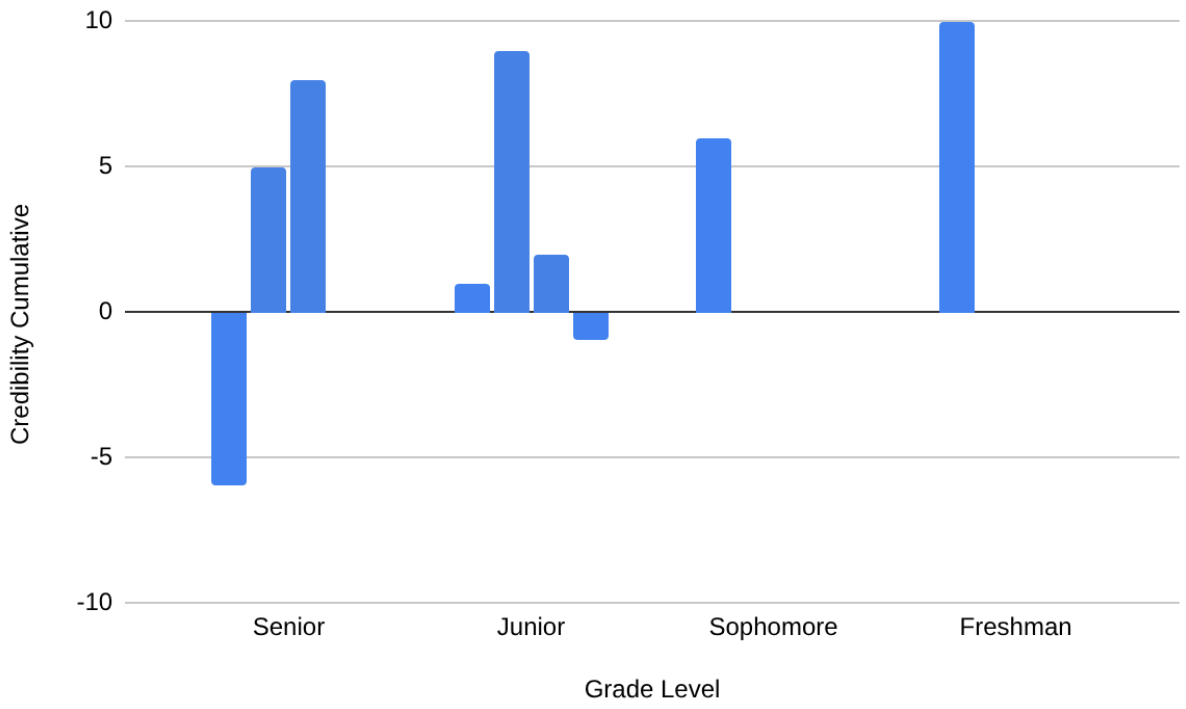


Figure 3 was focused on the same correlation between High School Grade and Credibility Cumulative but for V1. The correlation in V1was similarly weak, although it instead had a negative correlation. V1 had a correlational value of -0.4533528936 with the average score of 4 rounded up. Juniors had the highest overall Credibility Cumulative of 11 combined.

Figure 3: High School Grade vs. CC(V1)



All-caps vs. CC

The most important correlations were between title capitalization and. For all-caps, CC was calculated with several student responses for one title. For example, if title A had 10 student responses, with each student giving a score 1, that would have a CC of 10.

Figure 4 starts off with V3 instead of V1 because of the significance of the findings. To reiterate, V3 had seven sentence cases and three all-caps titles.

There was a strong correlation between title capitalization and the perceived credibility. As Figure 4 portrays, all titles that were all-caps in V3 received a noticeably lower score than sentence case titles. What's more interesting is that while sentence case titles have varying Credibility Cumulative scores the all-caps titles have the exact same score of -4. The correlation

value for V3 was a strong 0.88 rounded, with approximate average scores rounding up to 4. The highest score given was 10, with lowest as -4.

Figure 4:All-caps vs. CC(V3)

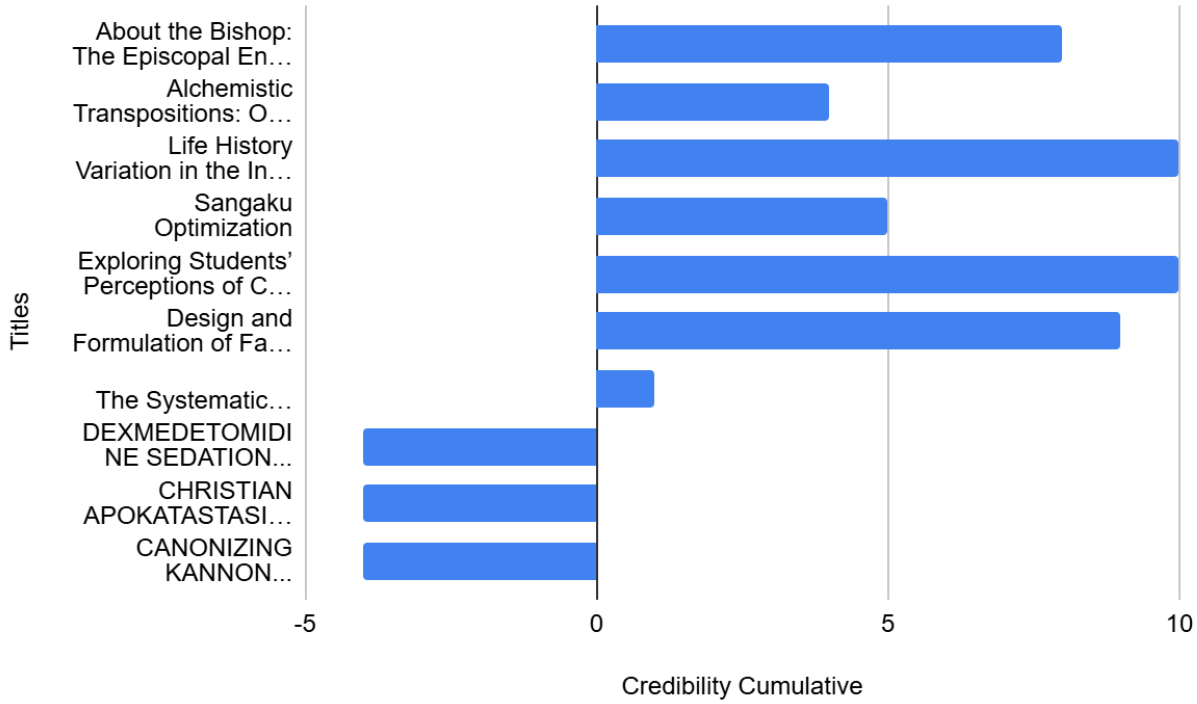


Figure 5 focuses on the same relationship between perceived credibility and title capitalization but in the context of the V2 form. To reiterate, V2 had seven all-caps and three sentence case titles. There was a weaker correlation between title capitalization and perceived Credibility for figure 5, which had a majority of all-caps titles. There are no discernable differences in how all-caps titles were scored and how sentence case titles were scored. The correlational value was 0.32 rounded, with approximate average scores rounding up to 5. The highest score given was 13, with lowest as 0.

Figure 5: All-caps vs. CC(V2)

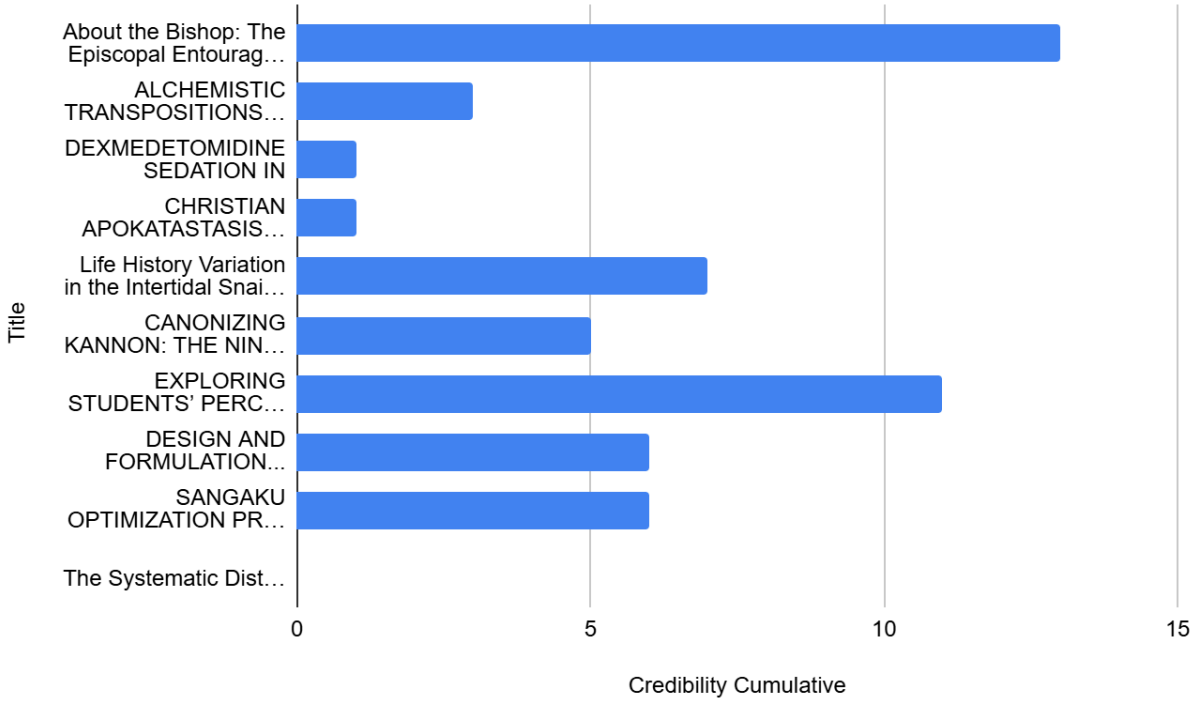
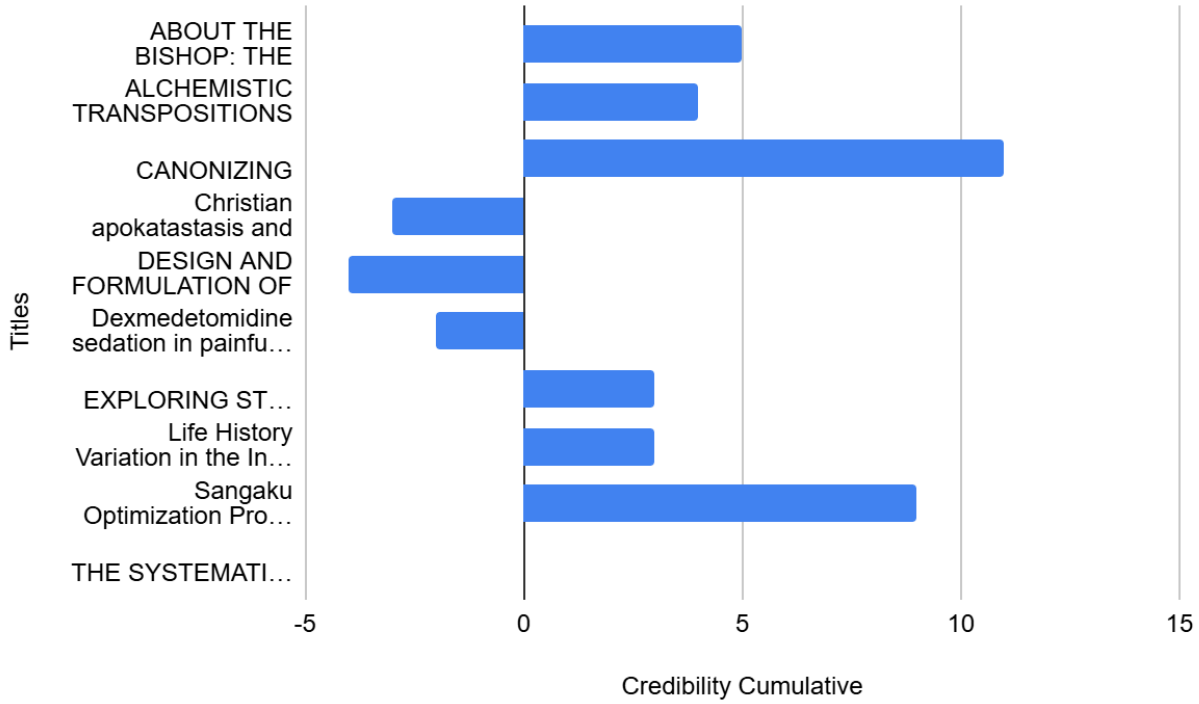


Figure 6 focuses on the relationship between perceived credibility and title capitalization but in V1. To reiterate, V1 had four sentence cases and seven all-caps titles.

There was also a weaker correlation between all-caps and perceived credibility in figure six, which has 6 all-caps and 4 sentence cases. The correlational value was -0.28 rounded, with approximate average scores rounding up to 4. The highest score given was 11, with lowest as -3.

Figure 6: All-caps vs. CC(V1)



Discussion

The research question of the study was "How does the all-caps style of titles for academic journals affect the perceived credibility of those journals in the eyes of high school students across grades?". In terms of database use, all students who took the survey had experience in using an academic database. The cause of this is easily discernible. School curriculums for any district are easily accessible through Rubicon Atlas For students who have gone to [redacted] since before [redacted] High School, they most likely already encountered academic databases. This is because in 8th grade Language Arts, a required class for students of the district's only middle school, [redacted], mentions database use as a resource

in the Social Justice unit. Even for students who just joined the district in 9th grade, courses like English 9 also require the use of databases for coursework in unit 4.

For Grade level, the results of the paper seemed to align with the findings of Estacio in that grade levels did not create a significant difference as to how students responded to the prompts (2018). Figure 1, 2, and 3 illustrates this. One example being how in V3 one sophomore had a score of 8 while the other had a score of 0, creating an inconsistency within a grade. And while in V3 and V2 seniors might have had the overall highest CC, Juniors had the highest CC in V1. The correlation between all-caps and Perceived Credibility varies between figures. V3, which had only three all-caps titles while there were seven sentence case titles, has the strongest correlation. V2, and V1 though, which have seven all-caps and six all-caps respectively, have far weaker correlations. In the scenario of V3, it seems like all-caps more closely resembles the effect of papers like Klinke or "Does your practice like social media?" had, where all-caps had a negative influence on credibility(2024 & 2011). The lower scores most likely suggest a prosodic quality similar to the latter, where all-caps is like yelling. It could also align with Pandey and others research about netiquette retention, suggesting that low quantities of all-caps reinforce lessons of netiquette that could influence student perceptions. However, V1 and V2 yielded responses that none of the sources within the body of literature anticipated. For example, with the title "The systematic distribution of vascular epiphytes: an update", in both V1 and V2 it received a CC score of zero. Interestingly, in V2 it was sentence case while in V1 it was all-caps.

In overall trends amongst all surveys CC scores were generally inconsistent or did not follow any major pattern..

There was an instance like for the title "About the bishop: the episcopal entourage and the economy of government in post-roman gaul". In V2 and V3, the title was sentence case.

Despite that, V2 still had a higher CC than V3 for the same title. There were times where sentence case CC was higher than all-caps, like for “Dexmedetomidine sedation in painful posterior segment surgery”. In V3 it was all caps while in V2 it was sentence case. V3 had a CC of -4 for the title while V2 had a score of 2. But then there were instances where all-caps actually had a higher CC than sentence case, like it was for "Exploring students’ perceptions of cutting-edge nursing simulation: a phenomenological study”. In V3 it was sentence case and in V2 it was all-caps. It scored a CC of 12 in V2 while it scored a CC of 10 in V1.

Titles seemed to follow their individual trends. That is to say that if a title was ranked highly or poorly, it would be ranked highly or poorly throughout each survey. Going back to the “Dexmedetomidine sedation in painful posterior segment surgery” title, its V1 score a -2, repeating. Two of the three all-caps titles in V3, including the aforementioned, were poorly rated in other versions. However, the title “Canonizing kannon: the ninth-century esoteric Buddhist altar at kanshinji” was an exception, being all-caps across all survey versions. While it received high scores of 5 and 11 in V2 and V1 respectively, it received a score of -4 in V3. This reinforces how all-caps can become a negative influence in credibility perceptions when it's the minority, because this is a title that in all other instances is highly rated. In fact, even for the other two all-caps titles in V3 the scores they received in that version were their lowest scores.

It seems the prosodic qualities are either mitigated or outright irrelevant to students when they evaluate academic titles. The subsequent conclusion is that all-caps influence in academic titles is entirely dependent on the quantity presented. Low quantities possibly make the titles feel like they are yelling, while high quantities have an indiscernible influence and students are more focused on the content presented.

Limitations

There were several limitations that restricted the scope of most conclusions. A noticeable drawback is the restrictive questioning about database use for students. I did not realize that, because of previous experience from courses at the middle school level, all students would have at least a nominal understanding of database use. Because of that, I did not consider using more expansive questions that could cover how often students use databases.. Another relevant limitation was if participants were more likely to respond to a title's content rather than capitalization. The use of heavy jargon was meant to deter participants from focusing on the word choice and content of the title. This was supported by the research of Bullock and others, which asserted that jargon hurts engagement (2019). Although, since all-caps only had a strong correlation with perceived credibility in where it had a nominal presence and other features like jargon became the focus of credibility for the versions where all-caps were the majority of titles, The last limitation was that the paper was underpowered, with only 24 participants and a 9-8-7 split for V1, V2 and V3 respectively. However, the true experimental design helps to remedy the low sample size, since the differing surveys allowed for meaningful diversification of data that could still present more results than just a single survey with 24 participants.

Implications and further research

The implications drawn from this paper, while small, will have the most noticeable impact on researchers with intention to publish reports on databases and students taking sources from databases. All-caps strains perceived credibility when it's less prevalent, so when researchers publish content, they could consider the presence of capitalization for titles on the platform. For students, the paper reveals that all-caps titles that are less common on academic

platforms does not necessitate that the quality of a paper is any lesser than other available sources within a database. All of the titles incorporated into the survey were high quality and peer reviewed for their principle. It is still important, though, to recognize that these implications are limited by the potential influence of jargon and limited questioning. Future research should eliminate jargon and instead use a different variable to establish focus on all-caps. Additionally

. Future studies could consider more comprehensive questions about database use, which this paper did not adequately possess to bolster a greater understanding of the relationship between grade level and perceived credibility.

This paper could also encourage future studies to consider lower levels of education rather than just high school, as the study notes how-at least for [redacted]- database use was taught at the middle school level. It is possible that students at that beginners level might yield different responses than at the high school level to capitalization. In addition, it might yield different results if future studies considered different regions. The curriculum utilized by [redacted]is not universal, so different curriculums that have different standards regarding database use could also result in meaningful distinctions for future studies. Future research could also consider using titles that are in the same principle. Most of the titles used in the survey were about different subject matters. However if titles were from the same principle, there is a possibility that results may have been distinct. This is, however, speculation that future research could verify.

By considering different stakeholders, platforms, and other stylistic choices that this paper does not, future studies can broaden the understanding of all-caps' influence in an academic context.

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Appendix A

PARENTAL CONSENT FORM

The perceived credence of fully capitalized journal titles in academic databases from the perspective of high school students.

This form is to request permission for your child to respond to a survey for a research project investigating how fully capitalized titles on academic databases might change student perception of how credible the journal is . Your child was selected as a possible participant because they are high schoolers, who tend to have more experience with utilizing academic databases than other students. The study seeks to see if full capitalization does an effect, is it negative?.

This study is being conducted by: a student in the AP Research course of the AP Capstone program offered at Ridge High School. This course is under the direction of [redacted], an English teacher at [redacted].

Your child's participation is voluntary. Because he/she is a student in the district, your consent is required before your child can participate in the study. Please note that your child will also be asked to indicate whether or not he/she is willing to participate. Parent and child permission are both required before your child can participate.

Please consider the information carefully and feel free to ask questions before signing off on your child's participation. If you consent to your child's participation, please sign this form. You can select to receive a copy of your response to this form.

Procedures

All participants will answer a 5 minute survey. The survey will be composed of 13 questions. 1 will give participants the choice to opt out if they ever feel uncomfortable. 2 are based on the participants' current year in school and their experience with databases. The remaining 10 students article titles and ask them
how credible they find the titles to be, with answers ranging from "I think this title is credible" to "I think this title is very uncredible".

Risk and Benefits of being in the study

Possible Risks:

There are minimal risks with participating in this survey. Your child may, although unlikely, feel uncomfortable with certain titles even though they have been selected from neutral topics. If that is the case, they have the option to opt out of the survey with the first question.

Benefits of Participation:

There are no direct benefits resulting from participation in this survey, but your child might recognize existing preconceptions they have when looking through databases, including if capitalization makes them perceive what could be a strong source as less credible.

Confidentiality

All information collected from this survey will be done so via Google forms . The level of analysis being performed is at the group level, so no names or identifying pieces of information will be collected. No information collected will be distributed. The records will be stored in a password-protected Google Drive for three years and will then be destroyed.

Voluntary Nature of the Study

Participation in this survey is voluntary.

Your decision whether or not to participate in the survey will not affect any class or transcript grades or records at Ridge High School. Questions on the survey can be left blank and your child is free to not submit the survey. If you or your child choose not to participate or stop participating, there will be no penalty.

Consent

- By signing your name on this form, you consent to your child being in this study, and can remove them from the study at any time.

- If you have any questions, please contact the AP Research instructor Dr. Daria Kuscenko, at [redacted]

……

Statement of Consent

Please indicate below whether or not you give your child permission to participate.

By typing your name below, you are acknowledging you have read and understand the information presented and you are giving your consent for your child to participate in the study.

Parent/Guardian Name

Select today's date below

Appendix B

STUDENT ASSENT FORM

The perceived credence of fully capitalized journal titles in academic databases from the perspective of high school students.

This form is to request permission for your child to respond to a survey for a research project investigating how fully capitalized titles on academic databases might change student perception of how credible the journal is . Your child was selected as a possible participant because they are high schoolers, who tend to have more experience with utilizing academic databases than other students. The study seeks to see if full capitalization does have an effect.

This study is being conducted by: a student in the AP Research course of the AP Capstone program offered at [redacted]. This course is under the direction of [redacted], an English teacher at [redacted].

Your participation is voluntary. Because you are a student in the district, your assent is required before you can participate in the study. Please note that your parent/guardian will also be asked to indicate whether or not he/she is willing for you to participate. Parent and child permission are both required before you can participate.

Please consider the information carefully and feel free to ask questions before signing off on your participation. If you assent to your participation, please sign this form. You can select to receive a copy of your response to this form.

Procedures

All participants will answer a 5 minute survey. The survey will be composed of 13 questions. 1 will give participants the choice to opt out if they ever feel uncomfortable. 2 are based on the participants' current year in school and their experience with databases. The remaining 10 students article titles and ask them
how credible they find the titles to be, with answers ranging from “I think this title is credible” to “I think this title is very uncredible”.

Risk and Benefits of being in the study

Possible Risks:

There are minimal risks with participating in this survey. You may, even though they have been selected from neutral topics, encounter a title that makes you uncomfortable. If that is the case, you can choose to opt out of the survey with the first question.

Benefits of Participation:

There are no direct benefits resulting from participation in this survey, but you might learn more about what preconceptions you have when looking through journal titles in databases.

Confidentiality

All information collected from this survey will be done so via Google forms. The level of analysis being performed is at the group level, so no names or identifying pieces of information will be collected. No information collected will be distributed. The records will be stored in a password-protected Google Drive for three years and will then be destroyed.

Voluntary Nature of the Study

Participation in this survey is voluntary.

Your decision whether or not to participate in the survey will not affect any class or transcript grades or records at Ridge High School. Questions on the survey can be left blank and you are free to not submit the survey. If you choose not to participate or stop participating, there will be no penalty.

Right to Ask Questions and Report Concerns

- You have the right to ask questions about this research study and to have those questions answered by me before, during or after the research. If you have any further questions about the study, at any time feel free to contact Dr. Kuscenko at [redacted].

- By signing your name on this form, you assent to participating in this study, and you can remove yourself from the study at any time.

- If you have any questions, please contact the AP Research instructor Dr. Daria Kuscenko, at [redacted].

……

By typing your name below, you are acknowledging you have read and understand the information presented and you assent to participate in the study.

Select today's date below.

Teacher's feedback

Teacher's Approval (signature):

_____

Appendix C

Survey V1

- Estimated length: 1-5 minutes
- I highly encourage that you look through the titles for at least a minute before you start answering the questions
- The following titles are extrapolated from JSTOR EBSCO and PROQUEST, all academic databases
- Your answer will reflect if you feel the title is credible. "Credible", in this context, means that you feel it's trustworthy or believable.
- All of these titles have a lot of technical terminology. You are not expected to know any of these terms.
- Your responses will be anonymous and not shared to anyone but me:)
- if at any time one of the titles makes you feel uncomfortable or, please don't

hesitate to just answer the first question and close the survey.

Have you completed the survey?

Yes

No

What year of high school are you currently in?

Freshman

Sophomore

Junior

Senior

Have you ever used an academic database (ex. JSTOR, EBSCO, Infobase, ProQuest) before?

yes

no

ABOUT THE BISHOP: THE EPISCOPAL ENTOURAGE AND THE ECONOMY OF GOVERNMENT IN POST-ROMAN GAUL

I find this title credible.

I think this title is very credible.

I think this title is credible.

I think this title is somewhat credible.

I think this title is not credible.

I think this title is very uncredible.

ALCHEMISTIC TRANSPOSITIONS: ON ARTISTIC PRACTICES OF TRANSMUTATION AND TRANSITION

I find this title credible.

I think this title is very credible.

I think this title is credible.

I think this title is somewhat credible.

I think this title is not credible.

I think this title is very uncredible.

CANONIZING KANNON: THE NINTH-CENTURY ESOTERIC

BUDDHIST ALTAR AT KANSHINJI

I think this title is very credible.

I think this title is credible.

I think this title is somewhat credible.
I think this title is not credible.

I think this title is very uncredible.

Christian apokatastasis and zoroastrian frashegird: The birth of eschatological universalism.

I find this title credible

I think this title is very credible.

I think this title is credible.

I think this title is somewhat credible.

I think this title is not credible.

I think this title is very uncredible.

DESIGN AND FORMULATION OF FAST-DISSOLVING MICRONEEDLES FOR THE RAPID TRANSDERMAL DELIVERY OF LORAZEPAM.

I find this title credible.

I think this title is very credible.

I think this title is credible.

I think this title is somewhat credible.

I think this title is not credible.

I think this title is very uncredible.

Dexmedetomidine sedation in painful posterior segment surgery

I think this title is very credible.

I think this title is credible.

I think this title is somewhat credible.

I think this title is not credible.

I think this title is very uncredible.

EXPLORING STUDENTS' PERCEPTIONS OF CUTTING-EDGE NURSING SIMULATION: A PHENOMENOLOGICAL STUDY

I think this title is very credible.

I think this title is credible.

I think this title is somewhat credible.

I think this title is not credible.

I think this title is very uncredible.

Life History Variation in the Intertidal Snail Nucella Lapillus Across a Wave-Exposure Gradient

I think this title is very credible.

I think this title is credible.

I think this title is somewhat credible.

I think this title is not credible.

I think this title is very uncredible.

Sangaku Optimization Problems: An Algebraic Approach

I think this title is very credible.

I think this title is credible.

I think this title is somewhat credible.

I think this title is not credible.

I think this title is very uncredible.

THE SYSTEMATIC DISTRIBUTION OF VASCULAR EPIPHYTES: AN UPDATE.

I think this title is very credible.

I think this title is credible.

I think this title is somewhat credible.

I think this title is not credible.

I think this title is very uncredible.

Appendix D

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